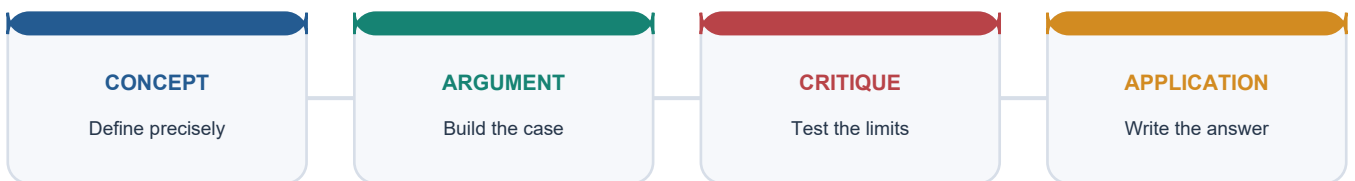


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Economy Topic 29: Solved Practice Workbook

Solved Practice Workbook

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Economy Topic 29: Solved Practice Workbook

Status cutoff: 10 September 2026.

Practice contract: Exactly 32 original MCQs appear before PYQs. Correct answers rotate A -> B -> C -> D eight times. Every option has a question-specific explanation and every MCQ has a unique trap.

Original MCQs

Q1. Which feature most clearly distinguishes mission-mode policy from an ordinary activity scheme?

A. A defined bottleneck linked to coordinated institutions, outcomes, review and an exit rule B. A large annual allocation administered by one department C. Use of the word Mission in the official title D. Distribution of the same input in every district

Answer: A

Option explanations:

- A. A is correct because mission mode connects a public problem to a cross-agency results chain, measurable outcomes, feedback and an explicit continuation or exit decision.
- B. B is incorrect because budget scale and a single administering department do not establish convergence, adoption logic or outcome accountability.
- C. C is incorrect because nomenclature can be political or administrative; the design test, not the title, determines whether policy is genuinely mission-mode.
- D. D is incorrect because uniform distribution may be a routine scheme output and can conflict with agro-climatic fit or local bottlenecks.

UPSC trap: Mission is a design property, not a naming convention.

Q2. In a mission results chain, which pair is correctly distinguished?

A. Training held is an outcome; adoption is an input B. Demonstrations conducted are outputs; continued profitable use is an outcome C. Budget approval is an impact; fund release is a counterfactual D. Area covered is always an impact; net income is an activity

Answer: B

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because training is an activity or output, while adoption is a later behavioural outcome rather than an initial input.
- B. B is correct because demonstration delivery is directly countable, whereas continued profitable use tests behaviour and farm-level value beyond supervised events.
- C. C is incorrect because approval and release are administrative stages, while a counterfactual is the estimated situation without the mission.
- D. D is incorrect because covered area is a physical output and net income is an outcome that depends on costs, prices and market power.

UPSC trap: Do not collapse the input-output-outcome-impact ladder.

Q3. Which sequence best represents a complete lab-to-land-to-market chain?

A. Research publication -> national target -> budget allocation -> press release B. Seed subsidy -> procurement -> laboratory trial -> variety release C. Research -> adaptive trial -> quality material -> demonstration -> adoption -> market -> feedback D. Market survey -> import restriction -> area expansion -> research

Answer: C

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because it stops at administrative communication and contains no multiplication, extension, farmer adoption or market conversion.
- B. B is incorrect because it reverses the technical sequence and places procurement before validation, multiplication and farmer use.
- C. C is correct because it moves from knowledge creation through local validation and delivery to repeated use, value realisation and corrective learning.
- D. D is incorrect because trade and area decisions cannot substitute for prior technology generation, local testing and farmer feasibility.

UPSC trap: A released technology has not reached the farmer until supply, use and market stages work.

Q4. Which monitoring design best reduces target-gaming risk?

A. Reward only the number of kits distributed B. Measure only the total promoted area C. Rank districts solely by expenditure utilisation D. Pair activity counts with sustained adoption, net returns, inclusion and ecological indicators

Answer: D

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because distribution can be inflated without checking use, timing, quality or resale.
- B. B is incorrect because nominal area can expand into unsuitable locations and says nothing about yield, profitability or persistence.
- C. C is incorrect because spending speed can reward weak procurement and does not identify public value.
- D. D is correct because companion outcome and safeguard metrics make it harder to optimise the visible target while sacrificing the mission objective.

UPSC trap: The easiest indicator to count is rarely sufficient to judge success.

Q5. The National Food Security Mission was originally launched in October 2007 with targets for

A. rice, wheat and pulses by the end of the Eleventh Plan B. oil palm, coconut and bamboo by 2030-31 C. cotton, jute and sugarcane only D. all horticulture crops under a single value-chain mission

Answer: A

Option explanations:

- A. A is correct because the original NFSM sought additional rice, wheat and pulse production by 2011-12.
- B. B is incorrect because oil palm belongs to the edible-oil mission lineage, while coconut and bamboo sit in horticulture-related structures.
- C. C is incorrect because commercial crops entered the widened architecture later and were not the original three-crop launch basket.
- D. D is incorrect because horticulture was addressed through NHM and later MIDH rather than the original NFSM.

UPSC trap: Apply the 2007 crop basket only to the launch phase.

Q6. Which is the correct current seven-component description of NFSNM?

A. Rice, wheat, pulses, oil palm, bamboo, honey and digital agriculture B. Rice, wheat, pulses, maize/barley, nutri-cereals, commercial crops and seed components C. Rice, wheat, horticulture, livestock, fisheries, forestry and irrigation D. Pulses, oilseeds, cotton, jute, sugarcane, tea and coffee

Answer: B

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because oil palm, bamboo, beekeeping and digital agriculture have separate mission or scheme placements.
- B. B is correct because the current NFSNM guideline lists the two staple cereals, pulses, coarse cereals, Shree Anna, commercial crops and the merged seed component.
- C. C is incorrect because it combines broad sectors outside the notified NFSNM crop-and-seed structure.
- D. D is incorrect because oilseeds moved to NMEO and plantation beverages are not part of the seven-component NFSNM list.

UPSC trap: Oilseeds and oil palm are no longer current NFSNM components.

Q7. What is the current administrative status of the former Sub-Mission for Seed and Planting Material?

A. It became the Digital Agriculture Mission B. It was converted into the National Bamboo Mission C. Its components were merged into NFSNM as Seed Components D. It remains unchanged under the original NMAET umbrella

Answer: C

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because digital public infrastructure has a separate Cabinet-approved mission and does not replace the seed chain.
- B. B is incorrect because bamboo is a MIDH sub-scheme concerned with a different biological and value-chain system.
- C. C is correct because current NFSNM guidelines expressly identify Seed Components as the successor to the erstwhile SMSP.
- D. D is incorrect because the old NMAET umbrella is historical and its four functions have been redistributed.

UPSC trap: A continuing function does not mean its old umbrella remains current.

Q8. Which statement about FY 2026-27 NFSNM figures is correct?

A. They are audited final achievements for every district B. They are statutory entitlements enforceable by each farmer C. They are historical Eleventh Plan launch targets D. They are Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework targets and must not be treated as realised results

Answer: D

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because the OOMF is prospective budget monitoring, not audited district-level actuals.
- B. B is incorrect because productivity and production targets are administrative objectives, not individual legal guarantees.
- C. C is incorrect because the FY 2026-27 table is distinct from the original 2007-12 production goals.
- D. D is correct because the framework records planned output and outcome indicators for the financial year.

UPSC trap: Budget-year targets are neither forecasts nor achievements.

Q9. The Technology Mission on Oilseeds is best described as

A. a historical mission launched in May 1986 and followed by several successor umbrellas B. the current legal name of NMEO-OS C. a component created under MIDH in 2014-15 D. a mission confined to imported oil-palm seedlings

Answer: A

Option explanations:

- A. A is correct because TMO began the oilseed mission lineage but was later subsumed and restructured through ISOPOM, NMOOP and newer missions.
- B. B is incorrect because NMEO-OS is a distinct current mission with its own 2024-25 to 2030-31 approval and guidelines.
- C. C is incorrect because MIDH is the horticulture umbrella and did not create the 1986 oilseed mission.
- D. D is incorrect because TMO addressed annual oilseeds through a broad technology and policy package rather than only oil-palm planting material.

UPSC trap: Historical predecessor and current successor must not be presented as one scheme.

Q10. Which statement correctly describes NMEO-OS?

A. It is the perennial oil-palm mission approved only to 2025-26 B. It is a 2024-25 to 2030-31 annual-oilseed mission that subsumed NFSM-Oilseeds C. It is the historical name of ISOPOM D. It is a sub-mission for honey traceability

Answer: B

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because the perennial plantation mission is NMEO-OP, not NMEO-OS.
- B. B is correct because the operative guidelines establish NMEO-OS under Krishonnati for annual oilseeds and absorb the former NFSM-OS component.
- C. C is incorrect because ISOPOM was an earlier integrated predecessor with a different crop and administrative design.
- D. D is incorrect because honey and pollination were covered by NBHM rather than the edible-oil mission.

UPSC trap: OS and OP identify different biological and administrative systems.

Q11. Which intervention is specifically central to NMEO-OS delivery?

A. Replacing all crop markets with one national processor B. Compulsory conversion of forest land to oilseeds C. Value-chain clusters linked with seed plans, demonstrations and processors D. A universal cash transfer unrelated to crop production

Answer: C

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because the mission uses multiple value-chain partners and does not establish a single compulsory national buyer.
- B. B is incorrect because the guidelines target suitable cultivation and fallow or intercropping opportunities, not forest conversion.
- C. C is correct because clusters, rolling seed plans, FLD/CFLD, storage and market linkage form the operational core.
- D. D is incorrect because NMEO-OS finances crop-specific technology and value-chain interventions rather than an unconditional income transfer.

UPSC trap: Cluster area, demonstration area and net additional cultivated area are different measures.

Q12. Which is the most accurate statement on NMEO-OP at the 10 September 2026 cutoff?

A. It was formally abolished in 2024 when NMEO-OS began B. Its original approval had no time period C. Its 2029-30 production aspiration automatically extended its legal tenure D. The original phase ended in 2025-26, while FY 2026-27 OOMF targets exist without a separately located extension order

Answer: D

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because NMEO-OS and NMEO-OP address different annual-oilseed and perennial-oil-palm systems.
- B. B is incorrect because the Cabinet-approved phase was explicitly 2021-22 to 2025-26.
- C. C is incorrect because an outcome horizon can extend beyond the approved funding period and is not itself an extension order.
- D. D is correct because it preserves both the later budget-monitoring evidence and the unresolved formal tenure document.

UPSC trap: Administrative tenure, budget target and long-run outcome horizon must be separated.

Q13. The commonly cultivated African oil palm is native to

A. tropical West and Central Africa B. the Malay Peninsula C. the Amazon basin D. the Indian subcontinent

Answer: A

Option explanations:

- A. A is correct because *Elaeis guineensis* originated in tropical Africa before becoming commercially dominant in South-East Asia.
- B. B is incorrect because the Malay Peninsula is a major production region, not the botanical origin of African oil palm.
- C. C is incorrect because the American tropics host a different oil-palm species and are not the origin of *Elaeis guineensis*.
- D. D is incorrect because India is an expanding cultivation region under NMEO-OP, not the crop's centre of origin.

UPSC trap: Production geography must not be confused with botanical origin.

Q14. Which pairing is correct?

A. Palm oil-kernel; palm-kernel oil-mesocarp B. Palm oil-fleshy mesocarp; palm-kernel oil-kernel C. Both oils-only the leaves D. Both oils-only the stem

Answer: B

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because it reverses the two distinct fruit fractions and their oils.
- B. B is correct because crude palm oil is obtained chiefly from the fleshy mesocarp, while palm-kernel oil comes from the seed kernel.
- C. C is incorrect because commercial palm oils are fruit-derived rather than extracted only from leaves.
- D. D is incorrect because the stem is not the source of the two named commercial oils.

UPSC trap: Palm oil and palm-kernel oil are chemically and anatomically distinct products.

Q15. Which statement best captures the current relation between NMSA and PM-RKVY?

- A. NMSA was a cotton-quality mission replaced by MIDH B. All NMSA functions ended when PM-RKVY was created
C. NMSA's resilience objectives continue while major delivery components are rationalised within PM-RKVY D. PM-RKVY is merely a research institute under ICAR

Answer: C

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because cotton quality belongs to cotton missions, whereas NMSA is the agriculture mission under the climate-action framework.
- B. B is incorrect because RAD, PDMC, soil-health, organic and agroforestry functions continue in the restructured current scheme architecture.
- C. C is correct because the conceptual climate mission persists while implementation is distributed across the PM-RKVY cafeteria.
- D. D is incorrect because PM-RKVY is a centrally sponsored state-flexible scheme, not an ICAR institute.

UPSC trap: Policy mission ownership and present budget placement can differ.

Q16. Which statement on NMNF is accurate at the cutoff?

- A. Its first phase had no approved outlay or cluster target B. Its 2026-31 expansion was finally approved in the cited OOMF C. It was only a state scheme with no Union approval D. Its first phase ended in March 2026, and later OOMF targets were expressly approval-qualified

Answer: D

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because the November 2024 approval specified Rs 2,481 crore, clusters, area, farmers, bio-input centres and model farms.
- B. B is incorrect because the OOMF footnote calls the later targets tentative and subject to approval of the proposed phase.
- C. C is incorrect because NMNF was approved as a centrally sponsored Union mission with state participation.
- D. D is correct because it separates the completed first approval from the draft EFC and tentative FY 2026-27 framework.

UPSC trap: A draft EFC plus budget target is not final mission extension approval.

Q17. Which set contains all six current MIDH sub-schemes in the May 2026 guidelines?

- A. NHM, HMNEH, NHB, CDB, NBM and CIH B. NFSM, NMSA, NMAET, PMFBY, PM-KISAN and e-NAM C. Rice, wheat, pulses, millets, cotton and jute D. KVK, ATMA, FPO, PACS, NABARD and NAFED

Answer: A

Option explanations:

- A. A is correct because the revised MIDH guideline combines two regional missions, two boards, bamboo and the Central Institute for Horticulture.
- B. B is incorrect because it mixes separate agriculture, insurance, income and market schemes outside MIDH's six-part structure.
- C. C is incorrect because those are crop categories associated mainly with NFSNM rather than horticulture sub-schemes.
- D. D is incorrect because these are institutions and organisations, not the notified MIDH sub-scheme list.

UPSC trap: MIDH includes boards and a technical institute, not only missions.

Q18. Which statement correctly distinguishes NHM and MIDH?

A. MIDH was replaced by NHM in 2005-06 B. NHM began in 2005-06 and now operates as a sub-scheme within MIDH C. They have always been identical names for the same administrative unit D. NHM is the current oilseed mission

Answer: B

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because the chronology runs from NHM to the broader MIDH umbrella, not the reverse.
- B. B is correct because NHM survived the 2014-15 restructuring as one component of the integrated horticulture mission.
- C. C is incorrect because using the names interchangeably erases the predecessor-successor relationship and the wider set of MIDH sub-schemes.
- D. D is incorrect because current annual-oilseed policy is NMEO-OS.

UPSC trap: A component can continue inside a newer umbrella without remaining the umbrella itself.

Q19. The current National Bamboo Mission is best understood as

A. a historical component closed in 2010 with no successor B. a digital registry for bamboo land records C. a MIDH sub-scheme covering planting material, cultivation, processing, skills and markets D. the seed component of NFSNM

Answer: C

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because NBM was restructured and remains present in the 2025-26 horticulture architecture.
- B. B is incorrect because digital records may support implementation but do not define the bamboo mission.
- C. C is correct because current guidelines use a full bamboo value-chain approach rather than plantation assistance alone.
- D. D is incorrect because NFSNM Seed Components concern the national crop seed system, not the bamboo mission.

UPSC trap: Bamboo area is an intermediate output; harvest, processing and demand arrive later.

Q20. What is the safest status description of NBHM after FY 2025-26?

A. Automatically permanent because honey output continued B. Merged into NMEO-OP C. Current through 2030-31 under a new approval D. The approved extension ended in 2025-26 and no later extension was located

Answer: D

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because continuing sector activity or assets do not extend a time-bound central-sector scheme.
- B. B is incorrect because edible-oil and beekeeping missions address different commodities, institutions and value chains.
- C. C is incorrect because no official 2030-31 NBHM approval was located by the cutoff.
- D. D is correct because it reports the documented phase without converting silence into continuation.

UPSC trap: Operational assets can survive after a mission period without keeping the scheme current.

Q21. The classic NMAET architecture comprised

A. extension, seeds, mechanisation, and plant protection or quarantine B. irrigation, procurement, crop insurance and warehousing C. horticulture, bamboo, coconut and beekeeping D. research, textiles, exports and customs

Answer: A

Option explanations:

- A. A is correct because the 2014 mission joined SMAE, SMSP, SMAM and SMPPQ as complementary diffusion functions.
- B. B is incorrect because these are important agricultural policies but not the four notified NMAET sub-missions.
- C. C is incorrect because these functions belong mainly to MIDH and allied mission structures.
- D. D is incorrect because it mixes institutions and policy domains that do not reproduce the NMAET design.

UPSC trap: Remember the classic four, but do not call the old umbrella unchanged and current.

Q22. Which current successor map is correct?

A. SMSP to DAM; SMAM to MIDH; SMAE to NMEO-OP B. SMAE to Krishonnati extension; SMSP to NFSNM; SMAM to PM-RKVY C. All four NMAET sub-missions to the Textiles Ministry D. ATMA to ICAR research; KVK to district finance

Answer: B

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because it assigns each function to an unrelated current mission.
- B. B is correct because current Survey, guideline and Outcome Budget documents show the redistributed extension, seed and mechanisation homes.
- C. C is incorrect because agricultural extension, seed and machinery remain agriculture functions rather than a wholesale textiles transfer.
- D. D is incorrect because ATMA coordinates district extension while KVK performs frontline technical extension, not district financing.

UPSC trap: Map the function to its current home instead of preserving an obsolete umbrella.

Q23. Which statement correctly distinguishes ATMA from KVK?

A. ATMA breeds varieties; KVK approves central budgets B. ATMA regulates imports; KVK procures pulses C. ATMA coordinates district extension planning; KVK conducts on-farm testing and frontline demonstrations D. Both are private processors under NMEO-OS

Answer: C

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because breeding and national budget approval are not the defining functions of these district institutions.
- B. B is incorrect because quarantine and procurement belong to other regulatory and market agencies.
- C. C is correct because ATMA is the district management and convergence platform, while KVK supplies location-specific technical testing, demonstrations and training.
- D. D is incorrect because both are public extension institutions rather than edible-oil processors.

UPSC trap: Coordination and frontline technical validation are complementary but distinct roles.

Q24. A frontline demonstration by a KVK establishes

A. nationwide causal impact of the mission B. automatic adoption by all farmers in the district C. a statutory right to receive the technology D. supervised field performance that still requires independent diffusion and outcome evidence

Answer: D

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because a selected demonstration plot cannot identify nationwide mission additionality.
- B. B is incorrect because observation may reduce uncertainty but finance, risk, tenure, supply and market barriers remain.
- C. C is incorrect because a demonstration is an extension method rather than an enforceable individual entitlement.
- D. D is correct because supervised feasibility is useful evidence but lies before voluntary repeated use and welfare outcomes in the results chain.

UPSC trap: Demonstration performance is not population impact.

Q25. The historical Technology Mission on Cotton used four mini-missions covering

A. research, transfer, market infrastructure, and ginning or pressing modernisation B. irrigation, crop insurance, fertiliser subsidy and export tax C. only biotechnology research and seed distribution D. cotton, jute, bamboo and banana fibres

Answer: A

Option explanations:

- A. A is correct because TMC joined farm productivity and fibre quality with market and processing infrastructure.
- B. B is incorrect because those instruments do not reproduce the four official mini-mission architecture.
- C. C is incorrect because TMC deliberately extended beyond research and seed to transfer, markets and ginning.
- D. D is incorrect because allied fibre diversification belongs to the later Navya Fibre component, not the historical four.

UPSC trap: Do not transfer the historical four-mini-mission list to the 2026 cotton mission.

Q26. Which statement is correct about the current Mission for Cotton Productivity?

A. It is the unchanged 2000 TMC B. It runs from 2026-27 to 2030-31 with three new mini-missions and a Rs 5,659.22 crore outlay C. It is a completed jute-sector mission D. It is a sub-component of NMEO-OP

Answer: B

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because the current successor has a new period, approval, outlay and three-part structure.
- B. B is correct because the May 2026 Cabinet approval established the five-year mission and its current architecture.
- C. C is incorrect because jute had a separate historical technology mission.
- D. D is incorrect because cotton productivity and oil-palm development have different crops, ministries and value chains.

UPSC trap: Current cotton has three named mini-missions; historical TMC had four functional mini-missions.

Q27. The Jute Technology Mission is most useful in an answer as

A. proof that all current fibre policy is administered by Agriculture alone B. a current FY 2026-27 central-sector mission
C. a historical example linking research, retting, raw-jute markets and industry modernisation D. a component of the current pulses mission

Answer: C

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because JTM crossed the Agriculture-Textiles boundary rather than belonging solely to one ministry.
- B. B is incorrect because the approved JTM period and reported activities belong to the historical 2006-early-2010s phase.
- C. C is correct because its analytical value lies in showing an end-to-end fibre value chain from farm technology to industrial quality and promotion.
- D. D is incorrect because pulses and jute have distinct missions and crop economics.

UPSC trap: Historical relevance does not create current administrative status.

Q28. Which statement about the Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses is correct?

A. It ended with the Eleventh Plan B. It is merely another name for NFSNM-Pulses C. It has no approved outlay or target period D. It is a separate 2025-26 to 2030-31 mission that must converge with NFSNM

Answer: D

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because the self-reliance mission was approved in 2025, long after the Eleventh Plan.
- B. B is incorrect because the dedicated mission has its own Cabinet approval, outlay, targets and procurement architecture.
- C. C is incorrect because official approval specifies Rs 11,440 crore and a six-year period with 2030-31 targets.
- D. D is correct because the standalone mission and continuing NFSNM pulse component are distinct but complementary policy platforms.

UPSC trap: Convergence does not erase separate approvals and targets.

Q29. At the Union level, millets are currently mission-labelled primarily through

A. the NFSNM Sub-Mission on Nutri-Cereals B. a separately verified National Millet Mission running to 2035 C. NMEO-OP D. the historical Jute Technology Mission

Answer: A

Option explanations:

- A. A is correct because current NFSNM guidelines retain Shree Anna as a dedicated sub-mission.
- B. B is incorrect because no operative standalone Union mission with that title and period was established in the audited sources.
- C. C is incorrect because NMEO-OP concerns perennial oil palm rather than millets.
- D. D is incorrect because JTM concerned jute fibre and is historical.

UPSC trap: Do not promote campaign terminology into a nonexistent current standalone mission.

Q30. Which factor most directly raises the adoption threshold for a tenant farmer considering a long-gestation technology?

A. A lower switching cost and secure multi-year tenure B. A short lease horizon relative to the period in which benefits arrive C. A nearby competitive processor and affordable finance D. Trusted local demonstration and repair services

Answer: B

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because lower cost and secure tenure reduce rather than raise the threshold.
- B. B is correct because the tenant may bear present investment cost while losing future benefits after the lease ends.
- C. C is incorrect because finance and processor access improve expected returns and lower market risk.
- D. D is incorrect because credible evidence and service availability reduce learning and failure uncertainty.

UPSC trap: Average profitability is irrelevant when the adopter cannot capture the future return.

Q31. Which evaluation finding would provide the strongest evidence of mission additionality?

A. National production rose after launch B. The mission spent its full allocation C. Comparable mission districts improved more than matched non-mission districts after baseline adjustment D. The ministry held more review meetings

Answer: C

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because nationwide change may reflect weather, prices, area, trade or unrelated technologies.
- B. B is incorrect because expenditure utilisation verifies an administrative process, not the outcome caused by it.
- C. C is correct because a credible adjusted comparison directly estimates incremental change associated with mission exposure.
- D. D is incorrect because meetings are governance activities whose frequency does not establish farmer-level impact.

UPSC trap: Before-after correlation is weaker than a credible counterfactual comparison.

Q32. Which is the best final decision rule for a time-bound mission?

A. Continue every component because institutions have been created B. Close every component on the same date regardless of crop gestation C. Rename the mission whenever a target is missed D. Use evidence to continue, scale, mainstream, redesign or close each function with a transition plan

Answer: D

Option explanations:

- A. A is incorrect because sunk administrative capacity does not justify an instrument whose problem or additionality has disappeared.
- B. B is incorrect because seed systems, annual crops, perennial plantations and infrastructure have different time horizons.
- C. C is incorrect because rebranding can hide failure without changing the causal mechanism.
- D. D is correct because a differentiated evidence-based exit protects useful capability while ending obsolete or harmful support.

UPSC trap: Sunset is a decision process, not an automatic guillotine or indefinite continuation.

Verified PYQs

UPSC CSE Mains 2018 GS-III, Question 13

Assess the role of the National Horticulture Mission (NHM) in boosting the production, productivity and income of horticulture farms. How far has it succeeded in increasing the income of farmers?

Demand: Assess contribution and state how far production and productivity were converted into farmer income.

Model answer: National Horticulture Mission, launched in 2005-06 and now a component of MIDH, adopted region-specific horticulture development rather than a uniform crop package. It strengthened quality planting material, new gardens and rejuvenation, protected cultivation, integrated nutrient and pest management, training and post-harvest infrastructure.

These interventions expanded crop choice and production potential. Clean planting material and protected cultivation can raise yield and quality; pack houses, cold storage and processing can reduce loss; diversification creates nursery, cultivation, logistics and processing employment. The 2026 MIDH architecture continues this production-to-market approach.

However, production is not income. Horticulture is perishable and quality-differentiated. Gluts, fragmented holdings, weak FPO aggregation, costly cold-chain energy, poor grading, distant processors and buyer power can reduce farm-gate prices. Higher gross revenue may be offset by planting material, labour, protected-structure and credit costs. Regional access also remains unequal.

Therefore NHM significantly strengthened horticultural capability, but income success has been partial and uneven. The next stage should combine accredited planting material and water-budgeted clusters with FPO bargaining, pre-cooling, processing, competitive market links, price intelligence and evaluation of net income, loss reduction and smallholder inclusion rather than area or production alone.

UPSC CSE Prelims 2021 GS-I, Question 52

With reference to 'palm oil', consider the following statements: 1. The palm oil tree is native to Southeast Asia. 2. The palm oil is a raw material for some industries producing lipstick and perfumes. 3. The palm oil can be used to produce biodiesel. Which of the statements given above are correct? (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept solution: Statement 1 fails the origin test: the commonly cultivated African oil palm, *Elaeis guineensis*, is native to tropical West and Central Africa, although South-East Asia became a leading production region. Palm-oil derivatives have food and non-food industrial uses, and palm oil can serve as biodiesel feedstock. Scoring is withheld because the matched final official answer key is not held in the verified local set.

Original Mains Practice

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish a technology mission from a routine agricultural scheme. Answer in 150 words.

Native-body alphanumeric count: 142

Model answer:

A technology mission begins with a defined production, quality, sustainability or value-chain bottleneck and makes several institutions jointly responsible for a measurable, time-bound outcome. A routine scheme may instead finance one input, asset or activity without owning the complete result.

The historical Technology Mission on Cotton illustrates the difference: research, farm-level transfer, market infrastructure and ginning or pressing were linked through four mini-missions. This chain treated fibre quality and value realisation as part of the technology problem. By contrast, distributing machines without repair, training, custom hiring or demand records only an output.

Mission mode therefore requires a results chain, convergence calendar, adoption evidence, outcome indicators, farmer feedback and a sunset or redesign rule. Yet the word Mission proves none of these properties; current status, funding and targets must come from the operative dated guideline. A mission is coordinated capability-building, not renamed expenditure.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why do demonstrations and seed distribution not by themselves prove agricultural technology adoption? Answer in 150 words.

Native-body alphanumeric count: 144

Model answer:

A demonstration is a supervised information event, while adoption is voluntary and repeated use under ordinary farm risk. NMEO-OS supports frontline and cluster demonstrations, seed hubs and distribution, but these are activities and outputs in a longer results chain.

A farmer adopts only when expected additional return exceeds purchase, finance, learning, transition, failure and market risks. Quality seed may arrive late; a new variety may require water or pest management; a machine may lack repair service; a horticulture crop may face no buyer. Tenants and smallholders also have shorter horizons and tighter liquidity.

Demonstration plots may receive selected farmers, closer supervision and free inputs, so their yield cannot be generalised. Evaluation should therefore track seed quality and timing, trial by non-demonstration farmers, repeated multi-season use, net returns, inclusion and agro-climatic fit. Demonstration reduces uncertainty; it does not eliminate economic constraints or establish mission impact.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Trace the evolution and current status of India's major agricultural technology missions. Answer in 250 words.

Native-body alphanumeric count: 203

Model answer:

India's mission architecture has evolved through problem-specific successors rather than one permanent scheme. The Technology Mission on Oilseeds began in May 1986, followed by ISOPOM in 2004, NMOOP from 2014-15 and NFSM-Oilseeds. Current annual-oilseed policy is NMEO-OS, approved for 2024-25 to 2030-31 with Rs 10,103.38 crore; oil palm has a separate NMEO-OP lineage. Its original 2021-22 to 2025-26 phase ended, although the FY 2026-27 Outcome Budget retains targets without a separately located extension order.

NFSM began in October 2007 for rice, wheat and pulses. Current NFSNM has seven components, including nutri-cereals, commercial crops and the former SMSP seed functions. A separate Rs 11,440 crore Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses runs from 2025-26 to 2030-31.

NHM, launched in 2005-06, remains a sub-scheme of MIDH, whose May 2026 guidelines also cover HMNEH, NHB, CDB, NBM and CIH. NMSA supplies the climate-resilience mission, while several delivery components now sit in PM-RKVY. NMNF's first phase ended in March 2026; its proposed next phase remained approval-qualified.

NMAET's 2014 umbrella is historical: extension continues under Krishonnati, seeds moved to NFSNM and SMAM to PM-RKVY. Historical cotton and jute missions must be separated from the current 2026 cotton mission. Thus chronology is itself an examinable policy skill.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the food-security and edible-oil missions as instruments of productivity and self-reliance. Answer in 250 words.

Native-body alphanumeric count: 204

Model answer:

NFSNM and the edible-oil missions address complementary but different bottlenecks. NFSNM uses cluster demonstrations, newly released climate-resilient seed, integrated nutrient and pest management, resource conservation and seed-system support across seven components. Its FY 2026-27 framework sets dated productivity targets, but these are planned outcomes, not achievements.

NMEO-OS, approved for 2024-25 to 2030-31, adds crop-specific value-chain clusters, five-year seed plans, 65 seed hubs, 50 specialised stores, demonstrations and processor links. This can narrow yield gaps and improve oil recovery and price realisation. NMEO-OP addresses a different perennial system requiring quality seedlings, gestation support, water and nearby mills. The separate pulses mission combines seed, area, productivity, processing and procurement.

Mission mode improves coordination where research, multiplication, extension, finance and markets are strong complements. Yet self-reliance cannot be judged by production alone. Weather, prices, trade and area affect national trends; import reduction may impose consumer or ecological costs; clusters may exclude rainfed or tribal farmers; oil palm can create water, land-use and processor-dependence risks.

Evaluation should measure additional yield and oil recovery, farmer net income, import exposure, regional equity, resource cost and public cost against a credible counterfactual. These missions strengthen domestic capability, but strategic resilience requires competitive productivity, ecological siting and diversified trade rather than autarky.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine how ICAR, KVKs, ATMA, states and value-chain institutions determine the success of agricultural technology missions. Answer in 250 words.

Native-body alphanumeric count: 219

Model answer:

Technology diffusion is a chain of distinct institutional capabilities. DARE and ICAR generate varieties, breeder material, protocols and technical validation. KVKs test location specificity through on-farm trials, conduct frontline demonstrations, train farmers and return field evidence to research. ATMA is the district extension-management platform: its Strategic Research and Extension Plan, governing bodies, block teams and farmer advisory committees coordinate line departments and local demand.

State departments convert national guidelines into annual action plans, select agro-climatic clusters, co-finance centrally sponsored schemes and manage seasonal delivery. Seed agencies and nurseries multiply quality material. FPOs, co-operatives and custom-hiring centres reduce smallholder transaction and machinery costs. Processors, markets, banks and insurers determine whether additional output receives finance, risk cover and remunerative demand.

Named mission design demonstrates this complementarity. NMEO-OS connects ICAR demonstrations, seed hubs, SATHI plans, value-chain partners and processors. MIDH links planting material and protected cultivation with cold chain and marketing. Revised ATMA guidelines require KVK convergence through joint visits and farmer-scientist interaction.

However, the principal-agent chain can dilute information and shift incentives toward expenditure, kits or nominal area. Strong governance therefore needs a shared outcome calendar, role-specific accountability, farmer verification, transparent cluster selection, service and repair metrics, and within-season grievance correction. The Union can set direction and standards, but state capacity and local trust ultimately convert research into repeated profitable adoption.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Design an evaluation and sunset framework for an agricultural technology mission. Answer in 250 words.

Native-body alphanumeric count: 221

Model answer:

Evaluation should begin before launch with a precise bottleneck, baseline, beneficiary map and theory of change. Inputs and activities-funds, staff, seed, training and demonstrations-must be separated from outputs such as area or assets, behavioural adoption, outcomes such as yield, quality and net income, and impacts such as resilience, nutrition, import exposure and ecology.

Additionality requires a counterfactual. Where randomisation is unsuitable, phased rollout, matched districts, difference-in-differences and multi-season panels can distinguish mission effects from rainfall, prices, trade and unrelated technology. Administrative dashboards should be checked against farmer surveys, field quality tests and independent audits. Distribution must be disaggregated by state, farm size, tenancy, irrigation, gender and social group. Ecological accounts should measure total water withdrawal, land-use change, pesticide load and rebound, not only efficiency per hectare.

Cost-effectiveness should compare public cost per durable adopter or income gain with alternative instruments. Convergence audits should assign each failed link-research, seed, extension, finance, repair, processor or market-to a responsible institution. Goodhart safeguards pair area with continued use, machines with uptime, and demonstrations with independent diffusion.

At scheduled reviews, each function should be continued, scaled, mainstreamed, redesigned or closed. Perennial crops and seed systems need transition periods; obsolete subsidies need sunset. Transparent failure reporting and asset-reuse plans turn a time-bound mission into an adaptive public institution rather than an indefinite label.